

Psychotherapy for Chronic Pain

Your thoughts shouldn't be consumed by pain too.

Living with chronic pain affects more than your body. It changes how you sleep, move, work, think, and connect with the people around you.

At Pain Clinic Australia, psychotherapy is one part of our multidisciplinary approach to chronic pain care.

It's designed to help you develop practical ways to cope with the emotional and psychological impact of persistent pain.

Take your life back from chronic pain today.

[**\[BOOK AN APPOINTMENT\]**](#)

Chronic Pain Isn't Just Physical

When pain is persistent, it can be hard to switch off.

You may find yourself worrying about when it will get worse, avoiding activities you once enjoyed, or feeling frustrated when your body doesn't cooperate with your plans.

That **doesn't** mean the pain is "all in your head".

It means chronic pain is complex and that it can 'flare' beyond the actual part of your body that hurts.

How Psychotherapy Helps with Pain

Psychotherapy can give you a **safe space** to *talk about the challenges of living with persistent pain.*

Depending on your needs, it may help you:

Become more grounded and empowered

Understanding your pain in depth may help you make better sense of the experience itself.

In turn, this shifts the power back to you. This also helps you deftly navigate triggers so you can meet each day in your own terms.

Manage stress and emotional distress

Persistent pain can be frustrating, exhausting, and emotionally draining.

Psychotherapy can help you develop healthier ways to manage stress, anxiety, frustration, and other difficult emotions.

Reduce the fear around movement and activity

After living with pain for a long time, you may start avoiding certain movements or activities because you're worried about making the pain worse.

With appropriate support, you can work towards rebuilding confidence in what your body can do.

Develop practical coping strategies

Chronic pain doesn't always follow a predictable pattern.

Psychotherapy can help you build strategies for managing flare-ups, difficult days, and the ongoing uncertainty that can come with persistent pain.

Improve your quality of life

Pain management isn't only about reducing pain intensity. It's also about helping you do more of what matters to you.

What Happens During Psychotherapy?

Your sessions are tailored to your individual experience.

Your psychotherapist will work with you to better understand how chronic pain is affecting your daily life and explore strategies that may support your wellbeing and pain management.

This may include discussing:

- How pain affects your mood and emotions
- Stress and its relationship with pain
- Fear or anxiety around movement and activity

- Sleep and fatigue
- Changes in work, relationships, or daily routines
- Ways to manage difficult thoughts and emotions
- Strategies for coping with flare-ups and persistent symptoms

There is no expectation to simply "think positively" or ignore your pain.

The goal is to give you additional tools and support for living with a complex condition.

One Part of a Bigger Picture

There is rarely a single solution for chronic pain.

This is why taking a **multidisciplinary approach to pain care** is recognised as the gold-standard by researchers and regulatory orgs.

Our team combines psychotherapy with modalities such as *tailored pain formulations*, *expert physical therapy*, and *dietary guidance* as part of a personalised pain management plan.

Some chronic pain patients also opt to get *complementary counselling* from our esteemed *intimacy coach*, **Nic Brewer**.

As chronic pain can also be due to underlying conditions, our experts may also work hand-in-hand with your primary healthcare providers.

[\[EXPLORE YOUR TREATMENT OPTIONS\]](#)

Frequently Asked Questions

Is psychotherapy only for people with a mental health condition?

No. Psychotherapy can support people living with chronic pain, *even if they do not have a diagnosed mental health condition.*

Living with persistent pain can affect many areas of life. Psychotherapy can help you develop strategies for managing these challenges.

Does psychotherapy mean you think my pain is psychological?

No. Chronic pain is real and can have physical, neurological, inflammatory, and other contributing factors.

Psychotherapy is not used to dismiss physical pain. It is one part of a broader approach to managing the many ways chronic pain can affect you.

Can psychotherapy cure my chronic pain?

There is no single treatment that can cure every type of chronic pain.

Psychotherapy may help you develop skills and strategies to manage the impact of pain and improve your quality of life.

Take the Next Step With Us

You've done well. From the social isolation and the stigma to the creeping self-doubt and grief over what life could have been... It's been incredibly tough yet you're still here.

We're very proud of you for holding on all this time. But, while your resilience is amazing, we wish that you didn't have to go through all the pain by yourself.

It would bring us great joy if we could become one of your support as you *take your life back step by step, one spoon at a time, from chronic pain.*

[CONNECT WITH THE TEAM]